# Terms of Reference

## Trade Fair Specialist

### Background

The International Trade Centre (ITC) is a joint agency of the United Nations (UN) and the World Trade Organization (WTO). It is fully dedicated to supporting the internationalization of small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs). It has a mission to foster inclusive and sustainable growth and development through trade and international business development. ITC Headquarters is located in Geneva, Switzerland.

ITC is implementing the EU Youth Empowerment Project (YEP) - Tourism and Creative Industries. The project has an overall objective of increasing the competitiveness, inclusiveness, and sustainability of the Tourism sector and Creative Industries in The Gambia. It has three main specific objectives of: a) improving business environment and institutional ecosystem; b) improving investment and market access; and c) increasing the competitiveness of MSMEs in The Gambia's tourism and creative industries. These will be achieved by implementing a number of key actions, including: i) streamlining and supporting implementation of strategies and regulation for the creative industries; ii) strengthening the technical and operational capacities of business support institutions; iii) building the branding and marketing capacities of actors in the tourism and creative industries; iv) creating market linkages and investment opportunities; v) building capacities of MSMEs engaged in the tourism and creative industries with a focus on sustainable and inclusive tourism; and vi) enhancing skills of target beneficiaries, mainly youth and women in areas which promote their employment in the tourism sector and creative industries.

The project addresses a variety of challenges and constraints of the sectors, which include a) weak sector coordination and regulations, b) narrow product offering and sub-standard quality, c) limited market diversification and strong seasonality, d) skill gaps, e) climate vulnerability, and f) low sector integration and limited positive spillover effects of the sectors to the wider economy and society. The implementation of the project will enable the Gambia to diversify source markets and attract more visitors year-round, including tourists with higher purchasing power, and to boost its offering of green and inclusive products and services of the tourism and creative industries.

The EU YEP Tourism and Creative Industries is financed by the European Union (EU) for implementation over a period of 56 months. The Ministry of Trade, Industry, Regional Integration and Employment (MoTIE) and the Ministry of Tourism and Culture (MoTC) are the key focal point government institutions for the project.

The project focuses on youth and women as the main target beneficiaries. It also puts a special emphasis on vulnerable groups by creating quality jobs and pathways for skills development, business growth and sustainability. Micro, small and medium sized enterprises (MSMEs) and public and private sector institutions, including, sector-based cooperatives and associations will be the target beneficiary groups of the project.

The objective of this assignment is to support Gambian tourism operators in preparing for participation in Global Birdfair 2026, taking place in Rutland, United Kingdom, from 10 to 12 July 2026, by strengthening their readiness for international business-to-business (B2B) engagement.

The consultant will assist operators in improving their product presentation, promotional materials, and pitching capacity, while supporting ITC and national partners in identifying relevant buyers and stakeholders within the international birdwatching and nature tourism market.

### Description of Duties/Responsibilities

Under the supervision of the Head of Digital, Markets and Connectivity, the consultant will undertake the following tasks.

**Task 1 – Assessment of Operator Readiness**

The consultant will assess the readiness of selected Gambian tourism operators, particularly those offering birdwatching and nature-based tourism experiences, to participate in Global Birdfair 2026 and engage with international buyers.

**Task 2 – Improvement of Operator Profiles and Promotional Materials**

The consultant will support the strengthening of operator profiles and key product narratives used in trade-fair promotion.

The consultant will:

- Review existing promotional materials such as factsheets, brochures (including GTB's digital version: Birdwatching at a Glance, where you can find over 550 bird species), and digital assets prepared by the operators.
- Provide targeted recommendations to improve the clarity and attractiveness of product descriptions and key selling points.
- Support operators in refining their tourism product narratives and value propositions for international buyers.
- Advise on improvements to the structure and presentation of promotional materials used during B2B meetings.

**Task 3 – Mapping of Potential Buyers and Industry Stakeholders**

The consultant will support ITC in identifying relevant buyers and stakeholders active in the international birdwatching and nature tourism market.

The consultant will:

- identify specialist birdwatching tour operators and nature tourism companies;
- prepare a shortlist of priority buyers and partners relevant for Global Birdfair engagement;
- provide basic profiles of these organisations to support targeted outreach.

**Task 4 – Delivery of B2B Preparation Sessions**

The consultant will deliver 1–2 preparation online sessions to support tourism operators in preparing for participation in Global Birdfair 2026.

Sessions will cover topics such as:

- expectations of international birdwatching tour operators and specialist travel buyers;
- effective pitching techniques for nature-based tourism experiences;
- packaging and pricing of birdwatching tourism products;
- practical guidance on how to engage with buyers during niche tourism trade fairs;
- key do's and don'ts when participating in Global Birdfair;
- basics of Canva for autonomous revision/editing of marketing materials.

**Task 5 – Development of a B2B Preparation Toolkit**

The consultant will develop practical tools to support Gambian tourism operators in preparing for participation in Global Birdfair and other international tourism trade fairs.

The consultant will:

- develop a concise B2B preparation checklist for operators;
- outline practical talking points for meetings with international buyers;

provide guidance on presentation materials and follow-up practices after trade fairs

***Copyright***

*The Consultant has to ensure that s/he has obtained the necessary permissions with regard to intellectual property rights required to perform his/her services under this consultancy contract and for the subsequent dissemination by ITC in any form. Documentary proof is to be submitted to ITC. Should any license fee be due for the use of copyrighted materials of third parties, the Consultant shall request the prior written permission from ITC. S/he has further to ensure to obtain accreditation to event(s), if required.*

## Expected Outputs and Timelines

The consultant will deliver the following outputs:

- Diagnostic of operator readiness completed, including a short assessment of product offer, pricing, and buyer-readiness for birdwatching tourism operators. **beginning of May 2026**
- Improved operator profiles developed, incorporating consultant recommendations on product narratives, key selling points, and presentation of birdwatching tourism experiences. **May 2026**
- Buyer and stakeholder mapping produced, including a shortlist of relevant international birdwatching tour operators, nature tourism companies, and key contacts to support targeted outreach. **May 2026**
- Delivery of 1–2 B2B preparation sessions covering buyer expectations, pitching techniques, packaging and pricing of birdwatching tourism products, and best practices for participation in Global Birdfair. **June 2026**
- B2B preparation checklist prepared, summarising practical steps, talking points, and trade-fair preparation guidance for Gambian operators attending Global Birdfair. **June 2026**

Final brief report delivered, summarising activities undertaken, key results achieved, and recommendations for strengthening The Gambia's participation in future birdwatching tourism trade fairs. **July 2026**

## Travel

No travel.

## Payment Schedule

| # | Description | Amount (USD) |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | First payment upon ITC's receipt of countersigned contract, and delivery of Output 1 | 480 |
| 2 | Payment after delivery of Output 2 | 960 |
| 3 | Payment after delivery of Output 3 | 960 |
| 4 | Payment after delivery of Output 4 | 960 |
| 5 | Payment after delivery of Output 5 | 960 |
| 6 | Final payment upon satisfactory completion of all outputs | 480 |
| | **Total:** | 4,800 |

*Fees are subject to the national income taxes, where applicable. If the contract is to be issued in a currency other than USD, the UN exchange rate on the date of the contract issuance will be applicable.*

## Skills

Proven track record preparing SMEs for major trade fairs (Tourism sector involvement is a plus)

Experience working in Africa and familiarity with MSME development programmes

Strong understanding of international tour operators and the birdwatching / nature tourism market is an asset

Experience working with African tourism destinations is an asset.

Excellent communication, facilitation, and capacity-building skills.

Excellent written and spoken English.

Sound computer literacy (including Microsoft Office tools: Word, Excel, PowerPoint)

## Education

Postgraduate degree (MA/MSc/MBA, PHD or other)
University degree in marketing, business administration, communications, international business, or a related field.
Extensive relevant experience may be accepted in lieu of the university degree.

## Experience

Minimum 5 years’ experience in trade fairs, or international trade development.
Experience in tourism marketing and international travel trade development is a plus.

## Language

Fluency in written and spoken English is required.